Nazism believed in hero worship. The idea that 'Germany is Hitler and Hitler is Germany' was instilled in the minds of the people. The concept of equality of human beings was rejected and Adolf Hitler was addressed as the "Fuehrer" (leader). In fact, Germany itself was called as "Fuehrer-State" meaning the 'Leader-State'.

ACTIVITY

Film Screening

Dear students, now you understand that Nazism inflicted genocide on innocent people. There are numerous films dealing with the atrocities of Nazism. For example, the film Schindler's List dealt with Nazi crimes and won many Oscar Awards. You can arrange the screening of the film in the classroom.



Nazism followed irrationalism and was vehemently against reason. Adhering to the philosophy of irrationalism it appealed to the emotions, sentiments and passions of the German people. Nazism recognized only single party rule. All other political parties were banned and suppressed. The party resorted to mobilization of the people. Organizationally, it was based on strict hierarchy principles with Hitler concentrating all power at the top.

Succinctly to state, Nazism is criticized for being totalitarian, irrational, racist and inhuman ideology. The defeat of Germany in the Second World War and the suicide of Adolf Hitler extinguished the Nazi party and ideology. The emergence of the liberal democratic political system in Germany based on competitive party system has denied scope for the revival of Nazism.

Glossary

Laissez Faire : In French language it means Leave Alone. The state should leave the individual alone to pursue his life

Market Economy : Economy driven by demand and supply

Social Welfare State : The state that implements various social welfare programs

Perestroika : In Russian language it means Restructuring. The former President of USSR Mikhail Gorbachev introduced reforms to restructure the economy

Glasnost : In Russian language it means Openness. It refers to the political rights made available to the people of USSR by its President

New Deal : The economic reforms introduced in the United States by President Franklin D. Roosevelt to reform American economy

Democratic Centralism : The organizational principle of the communist party visualized by Lenin

Signification of Communism : The adoption of Communism to suit the conditions of China by Mao

Hegemony : Moral and intellectual leadership as provided by Gramsci

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